



### OnePlus 9 Leaked

A real-life image leak hints towards 2 48MP rear cameras and a glossy silver finish for the upcoming OnePlus 9. <http://dgit.in/feb21-67>



### Xiaomi Mi Band 6

Codenamed "Pangu", Mi's latest smartband is rumoured to feature inbuilt Alexa and an SpO2 monitor. <http://dgit.in/feb21-68>

# OnePlus Band

## A worthy first attempt

**I**t was rumoured for quite some time that OnePlus was working on releasing a smartwatch. We're now in 2021, and we have the OnePlus Band being launched. Not quite the watch we expected, but definitely an interesting product. Why do we call it interesting? Read on to find out.

### Build and design

The silicon band on the OnePlus Band has a nice ribbed finish to it and has a dual-tone colour treatment. There are no physical buttons on the band for navigation and such, but the 1.1-inch AMOLED panel offers a fully touch-sensitive area, allowing you to navigate with swipes and taps. Charging is done by removing the core from the silicon strap and placing it on its dedicated charger. What we found a little annoying was the clasp.

In order to get the right fit around the wrist, you're going to need someone to hold the band in place, so that it doesn't move while you pull the strap in order to fasten it.

### Fitness tracking

The OnePlus Band offers 13 activities that it can track which include the usual suspects like running, cycling, swimming, yoga and more. The built-in SpO2 sensor is there to offer more detailed statistics on the workout you perform while the heart-rate monitor picks up the rhythm of your heart. We used the band to track a few evening walks and cycling sessions and concluded that for walks, the step count was reasonably accurate, and the heart rate data was in line with what was

being picked up by the Apple Watch Series 6. While cycling, the band delivers your heart-rate data and if you take your phone with you, you also get GPS data. The net result is that the Health app gives you your calories burned, and the heart-rate metrics. If you go for a ride without your smartphone, however, you lose the GPS-based information since the OnePlus Band doesn't come with GPS sensors on-board.

### Sleep tracking

The OnePlus Band also offers sleep tracking and thanks to the heart-rate and SpO2 sensors, is able to deliver quality deep-sleep data.

The OnePlus Band, in our testing, was fairly spot on with respect to the duration of sleep.

### Smart features and OnePlus Health App

While the OnePlus Band doesn't require a OnePlus smartphone, it does require the OnePlus Health App to pair and function. Pairing and setting up the band is extremely easy and swift, and we faced no issues there. The Health App, however, is not the most intuitive app for managing health data. The logic to see detailed stats is applied different to different sections (sleep vs. daily steps or daily steps vs. workouts). The "Daily Activity" tab shows you a 7-day calendar which starts with Monday, with the remaining 6 days being the 6 days of the future. This is completely wasted real estate, and it should have ideally showed today and the previous 6 days instead. Additionally, you don't get to see a detailed breakdown of your past workouts in the daily activity tab. There's also no

associated heart-rate data available in this part of the app. Step count is available through a different part of the main screen, but will only show you the total number of steps you've taken in the week/month/year, with the daily breakdown only showing up as a graph. The OnePlus Health app is clean for sure, but it still needs a lot of refinement. Ideally, all data for a particular workout should be available in a detailed manner in one spot.

### Battery life

Now, OnePlus claims 14-day battery life on the Band, which would be expected seeing how it offers very bare-bones sensors and limited smart capabilities. With no GPS on board, you won't suddenly find the band's battery drained by a significant amount, something that tends to happen with other wearable devices that come with onboard GPS. However, after 4 days since charging the band to 100 percent, it was already at 45 percent. We're not so sure the band would have made it to 14 days at this rate, but thankfully, charging the band back up hardly takes anytime.

### Verdict

The OnePlus Band definitely looks better than most others in this segment. This is also a band that offers a minimal but well-thought-out feature set. It is, however, lacking in some regards. The OnePlus Health App isn't as polished as competition. The OnePlus Band is also missing the stress tracking feature. While the experience isn't poor out of the box, the OnePlus Band does feel like a first-generation device that needs some time to get better.

—Swapnil Mathur

### SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSIONS: 40.4mm x 17.6mm x 11.45mm | NET WEIGHT: 10.3g | DISPLAY TYPE: AMOLED | SIZE: 2.79 cm (1.1") | RESOLUTION: 126 x 294 pixels | Blood Oxygen Sensor | 3-axis accelerometer and gyroscope | Optical heart rate sensor | 5ATM and IP68 | BLUETOOTH VERSION: BLE 5.0 | BATTERY LIFE: Up to 14 days | BATTERY CAPACITY: 100 mAh

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